

1846-50

MAY 1846

Following clashes in Mexican territory between American and Mexican troops, the United States declares war on Mexico.



Battle of Buena Vista, 1847, during the War with Mexico

AUGUST 1846

Wilmot Proviso proposes to ban slavery in territories acquired from Mexico. It is passed by the House, but not approved by the Senate. Divisions on slavery deepen.

FEBRUARY 1848

Treaty of Guadalupe Hidalgo ends the War with Mexico. The vast new lands added to the United States will be subjects of dispute between pro- and anti-slavery forces.

SEPTEMBER 1850

Congress passes series of measures known as the Compromise of 1850. On the one hand California is admitted as a free state, but on the other a stricter Fugitive Slave Act is passed.